

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; bile; metabolism; laboratory test; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The proposed image shows a full, asymmetrical liver with a domed major lobe, a tapering lesser lobe, a visible lobe seam, and an optional small gallbladder cue beneath the lower edge. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the broad lobed silhouette at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal relies on the direct literal meaning of the liver.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to say what the current symbols cannot say alone:

- Liver + Test Tube: a liver function test or liver-enzyme result.
- Liver + Pill + Warning: medicine-related liver monitoring or a liver safety warning.
- Liver + Hospital + People: liver transplantation, living donation, or transplant support.

These are established organ-specific contexts. MedlinePlus describes liver function tests, including their use in monitoring medicine effects, and NIDDK describes liver transplantation and living-donor transplantation.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Hospital + Test Tube can say "medical test," Pill + Warning can say "medicine risk," and Cut of Meat can say "food," but none identifies the liver. A Liver emoji supplies the missing body-site word in messages about liver-test results, medicine safety, transplantation and donation, anatomy, and food.

Current Unicode emoji list: <https://www.unicode.org/emoji/charts/full-emoji-list.html>

D. Distinctiveness

The image is broad and low, with one large domed lobe, one smaller tapering lobe, and a diagonal seam. At 18x18, those three cues separate it from the tall Anatomical Heart, paired Lungs, round Brain, marbled Cut of Meat, and multiple Beans. The green gallbladder helps in color but is optional; the outline and unequal lobes carry the identity in both color and black and white.

Liver	Anatomical Heart	Lungs	Brain	Cut of Meat	Beans
Color 72 					
Color 18 					
B/W 72 					
B/W 18 					

E. Expected usage level

Liver is a common standalone term across anatomy, laboratory results, medicine monitoring, transplantation, living donation, education, and food. That range is reflected in dedicated MedlinePlus pages for liver diseases and liver function tests and NIDDK guidance for liver transplantation. The five frequency figures below measure `liver` directly: worldwide Web interest is comparable to `e1ephant`, image interest is lower but sustained, and recent published-book usage is substantially higher.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/liverdiseases.html>
- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term `liver`.

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows a Google search interface for the term "liver". At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and the search bar contains "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are icons for settings, sharing, and a grid of apps, followed by a "Sign in" button.

Below the search bar, a horizontal menu includes "All", "Images", "Shopping", "Videos", "Forums", "Short videos", "More", and "Tools". The "Tools" menu is open, showing options: "Any time", "All results", "Advanced Search", and "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

The "AI Overview" section is visible on the left. It states: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below this text is a "Wikipedia +3" link. Underneath is a "Key Functions" section with a "Show more" button.

On the right side, a "Wikipedia" snippet is shown with the title "Liver - Wikipedia" and a small anatomical diagram of the human torso highlighting the liver. The text below the title reads: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which..."

Below the AI Overview, a search result from "Cleveland Clinic" is displayed. The title is "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy". The snippet text says: "Sep 26, 2025 — Your liver is located on the right side of your upper abdomen. Its functions include filtering blood, making chemicals and fighting ...".

Underneath the search results is a "People also ask" section with four questions, each with a dropdown arrow: "What are the first signs of a bad liver?", "What is the best drink to flush your liver?", "How do I fix liver problems?", and "Where do you feel liver pain?".

At the bottom, another "Wikipedia" result is shown with the title "Liver" and a snippet: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism".

Below the Wikipedia result is an "Images" section.

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

Google

liver

Sign in

All Images Books News **Videos** Shopping More

Tools

- Any duration
- Any time
- Any quality
- All videos
- Any source
- Advanced Search

About 72,400,000 results (0.20s)

www.youtube.com › watch

How The Liver Works

For more information about how the liver works, visit: <https://www.clevelandclinic.com/health/conditions/4wVclJE> The liver is a large organ in the upper right abdomen.

YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024

2:07

4 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains

For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: <https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant> or ...

YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026

4:43

3 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation

the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...

YouTube · Allila Medical Media · May 1, 2023

5:23

5 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English

At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...

YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024

2:20

www.youtube.com › watch

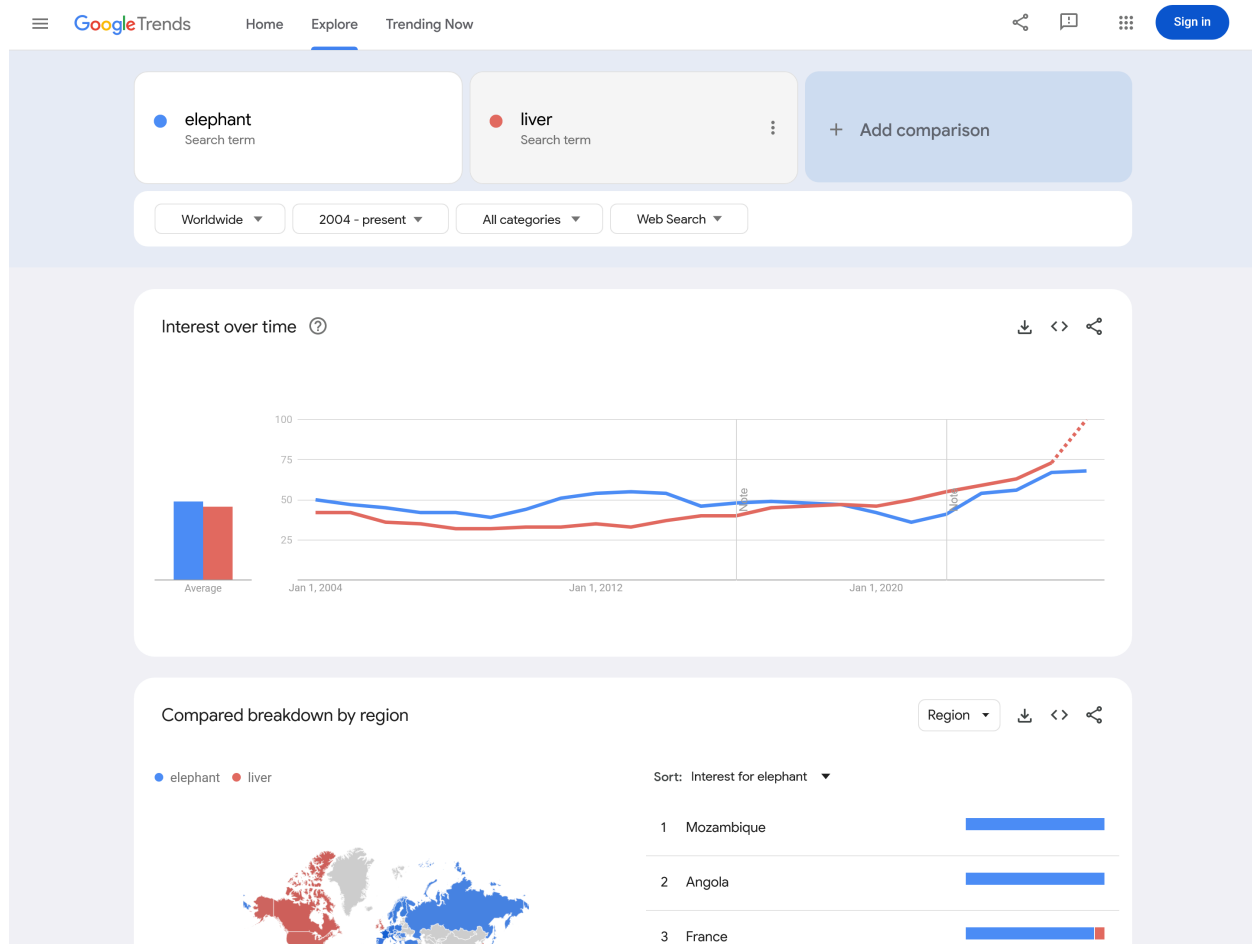
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms, ...

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

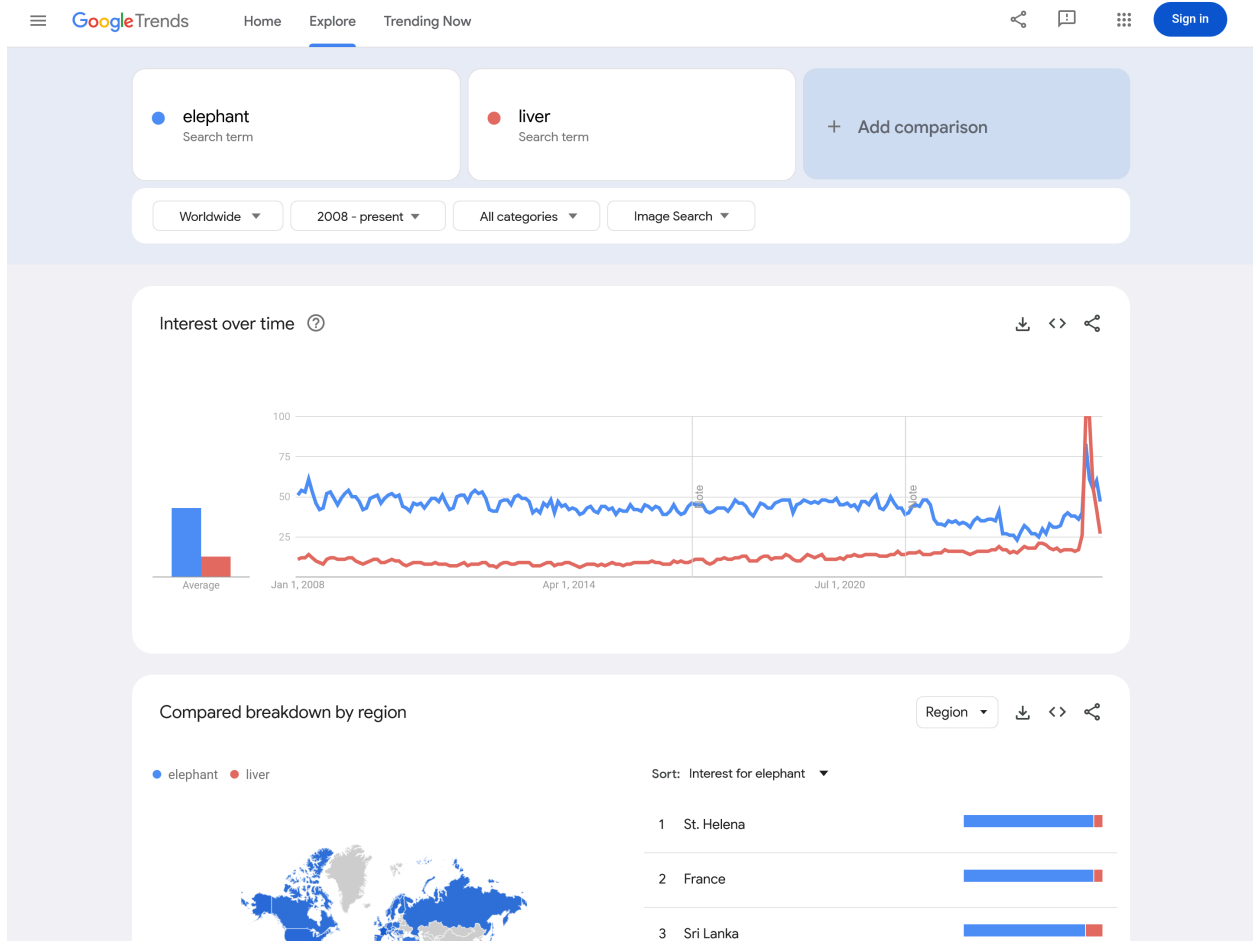
Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,liver>



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while showing sustained worldwide use throughout the period and a pronounced recent peak.

Reproducible query: https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,liver

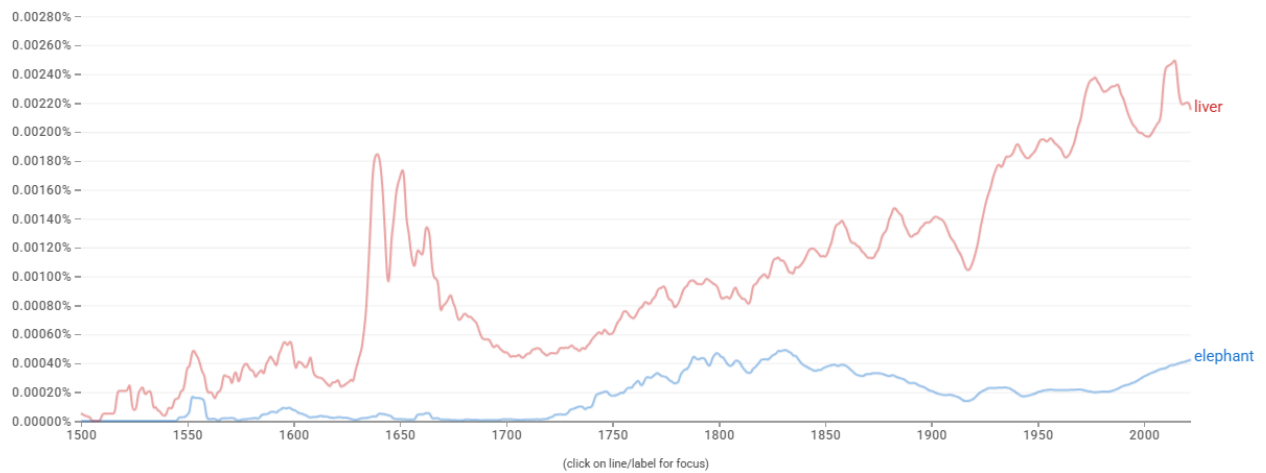


Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. Reproducible query:

[https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?](https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3)

[content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3](https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Liver is independently useful and is not proposed to complete an anatomy set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or a high-frequency pictograph in another system.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Hospital + Test Tube identifies testing, not the liver. Cut of Meat identifies food; Beans identifies beans. None can carry the organ name across medical and nonmedical messages.

B. Overly specific

The proposal is for the whole liver, not a lobe, disease, test, transplant procedure, specialty, or campaign. The same image can label anatomy, test results, medicine effects, donation and transplantation, and food.

C. Open-ended

Liver's case rests on a specific combination: high standalone term use; recurring messages about liver tests, medicine safety, transplantation and donation, anatomy, and food; and a compact two-lobe silhouette that remains distinct at 18x18. Those facts support Liver itself and do not establish an anatomy-series rule.

D. Transient

Liver is not tied to a campaign, event, or temporary technology. The embedded English-language Ngram traces the word through 1500-2022, while current MedlinePlus and NIDDK resources show continuing use in testing, medicine monitoring, transplantation, and donation.

E. Faulty comparison

Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain appear only to show what Liver is not and where it would sort; their encoding is not evidence for this proposal. The case rests on Liver's own frequency results, organ-specific messages, and recognizable 18x18 design.

Other Information

Essential design cues are one broad asymmetrical silhouette, unequal lobes, and a lobe seam that remains visible at 18x18. A small gallbladder, shading, highlight, angle, and exact red-brown tone are optional vendor choices and must not carry the meaning alone. Vendors should avoid a generic rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>